

Research Statement

1 Overview

I am currently a PhD student studying at Auburn University under the supervision of [Dr. Le Chen](#) and I will be defending my thesis in August 2022. Overall, my research deals with a space-time fraction stochastic partial differential equation driven by some type of Gaussian noise which varies depending on the problem in question. I will refer this equation as the Interpolated Stochastic Heat and Wave Equation (ISHWE),

$$\begin{cases} \left(\partial_t^\beta + \frac{\nu}{2}(-\Delta)^{\alpha/2} \right) u(t, x) = I_t^\gamma \left[\sigma(u(t, x)) \dot{W}(t, x) \right] & x \in \mathbb{R}^d, t > 0 \\ u(0, \cdot) = u_0 & \beta \in (0, 1] \\ u(0, \cdot) = u_0, \quad \partial_t u(0, \cdot) = v_0 & \beta \in (1, 2). \end{cases} \quad (1.1) \quad \boxed{\text{E:ISHWE}}$$

The ISHWE interpolates the well known Stochastic Wave and Stochastic Heat Equations, SWE and SHE respectively, in the sense that when we let $\alpha = \beta = 2$ and $\gamma = 0$ then we recover the SWE and when $\alpha = 2$ and $\beta = 1$ and $\gamma = 0$ then we recover the SHE. I have worked on problems that have dealt with proving existence and uniqueness of the solution, deriving the exact blow-up time for a local solution, proving the existence of invariant measures to the laws of the solution, deriving exact moment asymptotics, and proving regularity of the solution.

2 Past Thesis Projects

2.1 Invariant Measures of the SHE

My first project dealt with proving the existence of an invariant measure to the Stochastic Heat Equation,

$$\begin{cases} \frac{\partial u}{\partial t}(t, x) - \frac{1}{2} \Delta_x u(t, x) = \sigma(u(t, x)) \dot{W}(t, x) & x \in \mathbb{R}^d, t > 0 \\ u(0, x) = \mu(x), \end{cases} \quad (2.1) \quad \boxed{\text{E:SHE}}$$

where σ is globally Lipschitz satisfying

$$L_\sigma := \sup_{x \in \mathbb{R}^d} \frac{|\sigma(x)|}{|x|} < \infty$$

and the measure μ satisfies some integrability conditions given below in Theorem 2.1. The noise $\dot{W}$ is a Gaussian noise that is white in time and colored in space with spatial correlation function f . In formally speaking, this means

$$\mathbb{E} \left(\dot{W}(t, x) \dot{W}(t, z) \right) = \delta_0(t - s) f(x - z)$$

where δ_0 is the Dirac delta distribution. See [11, pg. 51] for more details.

The question of the existence of invariant measures in unbounded domains with dimension $d \geq 3$ has been handled in few papers such as [19, 1, 16, 17]. One thing to note is that the just mentioned papers use the theory of the stochastic integral laid out by Da Prato and Jabczyk in [12] while in my work we used the theory developed by Walsh [20]. The former develops a theory of integration with respect to Hilbert-space-valued processes while the later emphasizes

integration with respect to worthy martingale measures. The choice of either theory is one of mathematical convince as both have been proven to be equivalent [10].

To make a quick mention about the requirement, $d \geq 3$. Chen and Kim [6, Theorem 1.3] proved that a phase transition to the solution of (2.1) happens if and only if $d \geq 3$. In other words, in dimensions $d = 1$ and $d = 2$, the solution to (2.1) will exhibit exponential growth in time no matter how we control the coefficient $\rho(x)$. In order to prove the existence of an invariant measure, we will need to require that the second moments to the solution of (??) be bounded in t and this forces us to require $d \geq 3$.

Da Prato and Jabczyk have [14] established the following procedure

- Show the existence of a Markovian solution to the SPDE in question in a certain function space where the transition group satisfies the Feller Property
- Show that the solution starting from a particular initial condition is bounded in probability

Da Prato and Zabczyk [13] have also shown that the first bullet point is true for a wider class of SPDEs which includes (2.1). Zabczyk and Tessitore [19] follow this procedure to show the existence of an invariant measure for the laws of the solution solutions to (2.1) in two separate cases:

1. The initial measure is a function, $\varphi \in L_\rho^2 \cap L_{\hat{\rho}}^2$ where both ρ and $\hat{\rho}$ satisfy the condition that $\rho \cdot (\hat{\rho})^{-1} \in L^1(\mathbb{R}^d)$ and the solution is bounded in probability.
2. The initial measure is a constant function while assuming certain integrability properties of the spectral density.

By now using the theory of Walsh and a very important bound on $\mathbb{E}|u(t, x)|^2$ given by Chen [7], we are able to mimic the proof in [19], but in the language of Walsh, and show the existence of an invariant measure for a more broad group of initial conditions, which includes the Dirac delta distribution δ_0 .

InvMeasDelta

Theorem 2.1. *Assume $d \geq 3$ and that the initial measure μ satisfies the following integrability condition for any $t > 0$:*

$$\sup_{x \in \mathbb{R}^d} (G(t, \cdot) * |\mu|)(x) < \infty, \quad (2.2)$$

A: InvAssump

and that the spectral measure $\hat{f}$ satisfies both

$$\Upsilon(\beta) := (2\pi)^{-d} \int_{\mathbb{R}^d} \frac{\hat{f}(d\xi)}{|\xi|^2} < \infty, \quad \text{and} \quad \int_0^s dr (s-r)^{-2\alpha} \int_{\mathbb{R}^d} \hat{f}(d\xi) \exp(-(s-r)|\xi|^2) < \infty. \quad (2.3)$$

A: InvAssump

Now consider any pair of admissible weights ρ and $\hat{\rho}$ such that

$$\int_{\mathbb{R}^d} \frac{\rho(x)}{\hat{\rho}(x)} dx < \infty.$$

Then the solution, $u(t, x)$, of (2.1) starting from μ satisfies

1. $u(t, \cdot) \in L_\rho^2(\mathbb{R}^d) \cap L_{\hat{\rho}}^2(\mathbb{R}^d)$
2. $u_{t_0}(t, x) := u(t + t_0, x)$ is bounded in probability in $L_\rho^2(\mathbb{R}^d)$

In return, there exists an invariant measure for the laws of the solution, $\{\mathcal{L}(u(t, \cdot))\}_{t \geq t_0}$, in $L_\rho^2(\mathbb{R}^d)$.

2.2 Solvability and Exact Moment Asymptotics for the ISHWE [5]

In the project, we studied the the ISHWE with constant one initial condition:

$$\begin{cases} \left(\partial_t^b + \frac{\nu}{2}(-\Delta)^{a/2} \right) u(t, x) = I_t^r \left[\sigma(u(t, x)) \dot{W}(t, x) \right] & x \in \mathbb{R}^d, t > 0 \\ u(0, \cdot) = 1 & \beta \in (0, 1] \\ u(0, \cdot) = 1, \quad \partial_t u(0, \cdot) = 0 & \beta \in (1, 2) \end{cases} \quad (2.4) \quad \text{E: ISHWEone}$$

where $a \in (0, 2]$, $b \in (0, 2)$, $r \geq 0$, $\nu > 0$ and $\theta > 0$. The fractional operators ∂_t^b , $(-\Delta)^{a/2}$ and I_t^r respectively denote the Caputo derivative, the fractional Laplacian and the Riemann Liouville fractional integral. The noise $\dot{W}$ is a time-independent multiplicative Gaussian noise, in other words, $\mathbb{E}[W(\phi)W(\psi)] = \int_{\mathbb{R}^d} \mathcal{F}\phi(\xi)\mathcal{F}\psi(\xi)\mu(d\xi)$, where μ is the spectral measure with density given as $\mu(d\xi) = \varphi(\xi)d\xi$, and $\varphi(\xi) = \prod_{i=1}^k C(\alpha_i, d_i)|\xi_{(i)}|^{d_i-\alpha_i}$. We now define the mild solution to (2.4).

ISHWEoneSol

Definition 2.2 (Mild, local and global solutions). (1) For $T \in (0, \infty]$, a random field $u = \{u(t, x) : t \in (0, T), x \in \mathbb{R}^d\}$ is called a *mild solution* to the equation (2.4) if for all $x \in \mathbb{R}^d$ and s, t fixed with $0 < s \leq t < T$, $y \rightarrow G(t-s, x-y)u(s, y)$ is Skorohod integrable and the following stochastic integral equation holds almost surely

$$u(t, x) = 1 + \sqrt{\theta} \int_0^t \left(\int_{\mathbb{R}^d} G(t-s, x-y)u(s, y)W(\delta y) \right) ds, \quad (2.5) \quad \text{E: IntEq}$$

where G is the Green's function of the deterministic version of (2.4), ie when $\sigma(u(t, x)) \dot{W}(t, x)$ is replaced by a nice deterministic function.

(2) Let $u(t, x)$ be a mild solution to (2.4) (or (2.5)) and fix $p \geq 1$. We call $u(t, x)$ a *global $L^p(\Omega)$ -solution*, or simply an *$L^p(\Omega)$ -solution* if $\|u(t, x)\|_p < \infty$ for all $t > 0$ and $x \in \mathbb{R}^d$.

(3) If there exist $0 < T_1 \leq T_2 < \infty$ such that $\|u(t, x)\|_p$ is finite for all $t \in (0, T_1)$ and $x \in \mathbb{R}^d$, but $\|u(t, x)\|_p$ diverges to infinity whenever $t > T_2$, the mild solution $u(t, x)$ in this case is called a *local $L^p(\Omega)$ -solution*.

Because of the constant one initial condition, we are able to apply a Piccard iteration scheme to suggest that $u(t, x)$ and $\mathbb{E}(|u(t, x)|^2)$ should be given as the following:

$$u(t, x) = 1 + \sum_{k \geq 1} \theta^{k/2} I_k(f_k(\cdot, x, t)), \quad \text{and} \quad \mathbb{E}(|u(t, x)|^2) = \sum_{k \geq 0} \theta^k k! \left\| \tilde{f}(\cdot, x, t) \right\|_{\mathcal{H}^{\otimes k}}^2, \quad (2.6) \quad \text{E: ISHWEoneS}$$

where $I_k : \mathcal{H}^{\otimes k}((\mathbb{R}^d)^k) \rightarrow \mathcal{H}_k$ is the k^{th} order Skorohod integral and $\mathcal{H}_k$ is the k^{th} Wiener chaos space and the kernels $f_k(\cdot, x, t)$ are obtained through the iteration to be

$$f_n(x_1, \dots, x_k; x, t) = \int_0^t \int_0^{t_n} \cdots \int_0^{t_2} G(t-t_n, x-x_n) \cdots G(t_2-t_1, x_2-x_1) dt_1 \cdots dt_n.$$

This is made legitimate in the next Theorem.

SHWEoneSol

Theorem 2.3 ([5, Theorem 1.6]). *We assume some mild assumptions on the parameters of (2.4) which guarantees the non-negativity of $G(t, x)$. This assumption does not exclude the SHE and SWE.*

(1) (2.4) has a unique (global) solution $u(t, x)$, given in (2.6), in $L^p(\Omega)$ for all $p \geq 2$, $t > 0$, and $x \in \mathbb{R}^d$ provided that

$$0 < \alpha < \min \left(\frac{a}{b} [2(b+r) - 1], 2a, d \right). \quad (2.7) \quad \text{E: alpha}$$

(2) Otherwise, if

$$r \in [0, 1/2) \quad \text{and} \quad 0 < \alpha = \frac{a}{b} [2(b+r) - 1] \leq d, \quad (2.8) \quad \text{E: critical}$$

then (2.4) has a local solution in the sense that

(2-i) For any $p \geq 2$, (2.4) has a unique solution $u(t, x)$ in $L^p(\Omega)$ for all $p \geq 2$ and $x \in \mathbb{R}^d$, but only for $t \in (0, T_p)$ where

$$T_p := \frac{\nu^{\alpha/a}}{2\theta(p-1)\mathcal{M}_a^{(2a-\alpha)/a}}. \quad (2.9) \quad \boxed{\text{E:Tp}}$$

(2-ii) For any $t > T_2$, the series defining $\mathbb{E}(|u(t, x)|^2)$ in (2.6) diverges, that is, the $L^2(\Omega)$ -solution $u(t, x)$ to (2.4) does not exist whenever $t > T_2$.

The constant $\mathcal{M}_a$ is defined in [5, Equation (3.11)] and is shown to be finite in Theorem 3.5 (*ibid.*). The second main result of this project deals with finding an exact formula the asymptotic behavior of the moments of the solution.

Theorem 2.4 ([5, Corollary 1.8]). *Under the assumptions of Theorem 2.3 and if we assume (2.7), then*

1. For all $p \geq 2$ fixed, it holds that

$$\begin{aligned} \lim_{t \rightarrow \infty} t^{-\beta} \log \mathbb{E}(|u(t, x)|^p) = & p(p-1)^{\frac{1}{2(b+r)-\frac{b\alpha}{a}-1}} \left(\frac{1}{2}\right) \left(\frac{2a}{2a(b+r)-b\alpha}\right)^{\beta} \\ & \times \left(\theta \nu^{-\alpha/a} \mathcal{M}_a^{\frac{2a-\alpha}{a}}\right)^{\frac{a}{2a(b+r)-b\alpha-a}} \left(2(b+r) - \frac{b\alpha}{a} - 1\right); \end{aligned} \quad (2.10) \quad \boxed{\text{E:momentasy}}$$

2. For all $t > 0$ fixed, it holds that

$$\begin{aligned} \lim_{p \rightarrow \infty} p^{-\beta} \log \mathbb{E}(|u(t, x)|^p) = & t^{\beta} \left(\frac{1}{2}\right) \left(\frac{2a}{2a(b+r)-b\alpha}\right)^{\beta} \\ & \times \left(\theta \nu^{-\alpha/a} \mathcal{M}_a^{\frac{2a-\alpha}{a}}\right)^{\frac{a}{2a(b+r)-b\alpha-a}} \left(2(b+r) - \frac{b\alpha}{a} - 1\right). \end{aligned} \quad (2.11) \quad \boxed{\text{E:momentasy}}$$

It is important to know that under the case of the SWE, ie $a = b = 2$ and $r = 0$ then our results recover the work of Balan *et al* [3] and under the case of the SHE, ie $a = 2$, $b = 1$ and $r = 0$ our results recover the work of Chen [4, Theorem 1.1 and Theorem 1.2]] when we set $\alpha_0 = 0$.

3 Current Thesis Project

3.1 Solvability of the ISHWE With Superlinear Diffusion Term

My current project deals with proving the existence and uniqueness of global solutions to (1.1) with a super-linear diffusion term σ that satisfies the following growth condition: as $|x| \rightarrow \infty$,

$$|\sigma(x)| \leq \sigma_1 + \sigma_2 |x| [\ln(|x|)]^{\delta}, \quad (3.1)$$

where $\sigma_1 = c(\sigma) = \sigma(0)$. The work is an extension of Millet and Sanz-Solé [18]. It is often the case that blow of the solution to SPDE's will occur when considering a super-linear diffusion coefficient. For example, Asogwa *et al* [2] study (1.1) where $\beta \in (0, 1]$, $\alpha \in (0, 2)$, and $\gamma = 1 - \beta$. They prove in Theorem 1.2 that blow up will occur in finite time when the diffusion coefficient has super linear growth and is bounded below by a non-zero constant. The techniques in their paper can also be easily adapted (1.1) for $\beta \in (0, 2)$, $\alpha \in (0, 2)$ and $\gamma > 0$.

In this project, we require the initial conditions, u_0 and v_0 , to be bounded bounded Borel functions and the noise $\dot{W}$ may either be space-time white or white in time and colored in space. When the noise is colored in space, we take the correlation function to be the Riesz kernel. As of

now, I have more or less completed the case of space-time white noise but the same techniques should also apply to the colored noise case as well.

I will now outline the steps, proving the existence of a global solution to (1.1) driven by space-time white noise. We first consider the case where the diffusion coefficient σ is globally Lipschitz. In this case, existence and uniqueness is proven in [8, Theorem 3.1]. The first step was to prove the next proposition. We note that this Hölder regularity proven in Proposition 3.1 below recovers [15, Theorem 1.9].

P:Holder

Proposition 3.1. *Suppose that $u_0 = 1$ and $v_0 = 0$ and $\Theta := 2\alpha + \frac{\alpha}{\beta} \min\{2\gamma - 1, 0\}$. Then u has a version, still denoted by u , that is η_1 -Hölder continuous in time and η_2 -Hölder continuous in space with $0 < \eta_1 < q/2$ and $0 < \eta_2 < \theta/2$ where $0 < \theta < (\Theta - 1) \wedge 2$ and*

1. $0 < q \leq \rho$ under when $0 < \beta \leq 1$ and $\gamma \leq \lceil \beta \rceil - \beta$,
2. $0 < q < \rho$ under $0 < \alpha < 2$ and $0 < \beta < 2$.

Moreover, if we consider

$$a > (8L^2(\sigma)K^2)^{1/\rho} \quad \text{and} \quad p \in \left[2, \frac{a^\rho}{4L^2(\sigma)K^2}\right],$$

where K is specific constant whose definition at the moment is unimportant, then we have that for any $R > 0$,

$$\mathbb{E} \left[\sup_{t \in [0, T], |x| \leq R} |u(t, x)|^p \right] \leq 2^{p-1} + C(p, \theta, T, R) \left[\mathcal{M}_1^p + \mathcal{M}_2^p e^{apT} \left(2 + \frac{c(\sigma)}{L(\sigma)} \right)^p \right].$$

After proving this proposition, we can consider proving the existence of a global solution to (1.1) with a super-linear diffusion coefficient that as $|x| \rightarrow \infty$,

$$|\sigma(x)| \leq \sigma_1 + \sigma_2 |x| [\ln(|x|)]^\delta. \quad (3.2)$$

C:SigSupLin

where $\sigma_1 = c(\sigma) = \sigma(0)$. What we do now is truncate σ in following sense:

$$\sigma_N(x) = \sigma(x) \mathbf{1}_{\{|x| \leq N\}} + \sigma(N) \mathbf{1}_{\{x > N\}} + \sigma(-N) \mathbf{1}_{\{x \leq -N\}}.$$

This can also be done analogously in higher dimensions. For each N , σ_N is globally Lipschitz and so for each N we have the solution $u_N(t, x)$ where u_N is the solution to (1.1) with σ replaced by σ_N . If we define τ_N to be the following stopping time,

$$\tau_N := \inf \left\{ t > 0 : \sup_{|x| \leq R} |u_N(t, x)| \geq N \right\} \wedge T, \quad (3.3)$$

then through a bit of analysis we deduce that $\tau_N \uparrow \infty$ as $N \rightarrow \infty$ and that on $\{t < \tau_N\}$, $u_N(t, x) = u_{N+k}(t, x)$ for any $k \in \mathbb{N}$. Lastly, we define on each $\{t < \tau_N\}$, $(u(t, x) : (t, x) \in [0, T] \times \mathbb{R})$ by $u(t, x) = u_N(t, x)$. A little more analysis shows that u is a global solution to (1.1). Thus we have our next theorem.

Theorem 3.2. *Consider the initial conditions $u_0 = 1$ and $v_0 = 0$ and suppose that σ satisfies (3.2). Then for any $M > 0$ and $T > 0$, there exists a random field solution to (1.1) in $[-M, M]^d$ denoted as $(u(t, x) : (t, x) \in [0, T] \times [-M, M])$. This solution is unique and satisfies*

$$\sup_{t \in [0, T], |x| \leq M} |u(t, x)| < \infty, \text{ a.s.} \quad (3.4)$$

One last thing to note here is that the solution u constructed in the above theorem is not defined in $L^2(\Omega)$. In order to define u , we use an extension of the Walsh integral which can be found in [9]

4 Future Projects

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